

17. Consider the following statements:

1. The “Bombay Manifesto” signed in 1936 openly opposed the preaching of socialist ideals.
2. It evoked support from a large section of the business community from all across India.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

I.A.S. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (c)

‘Bombay Manifesto’ was a deal that was signed in the year 1936 by 21 businessmen. It contained an open indictment of Nehru’s preaching of socialist ideas during Lucknow session. It was largely supported by the business community. So both the statements are true.

Provincial Election and Formation of Cabinet (1937)

*On the basis of Government of India Act, 1935, in February 1937, election results were announced of provincial legislatures in which Congress by defeating its opponents secured majority in five provinces.

1. Madras (159 seats out of total 215 seats) - Congress
2. Bihar (98 seats out of total 152 seats) - Congress
3. Central Province and Berar (70 out of 112) - Congress
4. United Province (134 seats out of 228) - Congress
5. Orissa (36 out of 60 seats) - Congress

* Congress emerged as the single largest party in Bombay (86 seats out of 175), Assam and North-West Frontier Province. Only in Bengal, Punjab and Sindh did Congress not secure enough support from masses to form the government on its own. The cabinets formed by Congress after 1936-37 A.D. elections only lasted for 28 months. In **July 1937 A.D.**, Congress formed cabinets in **6 provinces - Madras, Bombay, Central Province, Orissa, Bihar, and United Province** and with the support of other parties Congress formed a coalition government in Assam and North-West Frontier Provinces. The inclusion of Indians into the Second World War without the permission of Congress cabinets led to the resignation of all Congress cabinets. On **22nd October, 1939 A.D.** Congress cabinet of all provinces resigned as an act of protest. Being happy with Congress cabinets, resignation Jinnah called Indian Muslims to celebrate **22nd December, 1939 A.D.** as a **Day of Deliverance**. *Working Committee of Indian National Congress decided to end land ownership in 1937 A.D. as a result of which Congress governments in U.P. and Bihar passed tenancy bills. Congress secured 134 seats out of 228 seats in United Province and

formed government on its own. ***Govind Vallabh Pant** was the Prime Minister (Premier) while Kailash Nath Katju was Law and Justice Minister and Finance Ministry was given to Rafi Ahmed Kidwai. * In Congress-ruled states the reports related to Muslims grievances were in the following chronological order.

- Pirpur Report - 1938
- Sharif Report - March, 1939
- Fazlul Haq Report (Muslims Suffering Under Congress Rule Report) - December, 1939

1. In which of the following provinces did the Indian National Congress not obtain a full majority in provincial legislature elections held in 1937?

- (a) Central Province (b) Bihar
(c) Punjab (d) Madras

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1992

Ans. (c)

Provincial assembly elections were held under the Indian Government Act, 1935 in which Congress won a full majority in 5 provinces – Madras, Bihar, Central Provinces and Berar, United Province and Orissa. Congress made its ministries in 6 states: Madras, Central Province, Bihar, Bombay, Orissa and United Province in July, 1937 A.D. Only in Bengal, Punjab and Sindh Congress did not secure enough support.

2. The Provincial Governments were constituted under the Act of-

- (a) 1935 (b) 1932
(c) 1936 (d) 1947

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

3. In which of the following States did Congress not win an absolute majority in the elections for the Legislative Assemblies which were held under the 1935 Act?

- (a) Madras (b) Bihar
(c) Orissa (d) Bengal

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2004

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

4. In 1937 elections, Congress secured a clear majority in the state numbering.

- (a) Three (b) Four
(c) Five (d) Six

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

5. Consider the following provinces of British India and identify those where the Indian National Congress did not form a ministry in 1937?

1. Central 2. Orissa
3. Bengal 4. Punjab

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

- (a) 1 and 2 (b) 3 and 4
- (c) 2 and 3 (d) 1 and 4

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (b)

Indian provincial elections were held in 1936-37 A.D. mandated by Government of India Act 1935. The elections were held in eleven provinces, i.e., - Madras, Central Province, Bihar, Orissa, United Province, Bombay, Assam, NWFP, Bengal, Punjab and Sindh. The results of the election were declared in February, 1937 A.D. and Indian Congress emerged as a power in eight provinces (5 provinces with full majority) except Bengal, Punjab and Sindh.

6. The province where the Indian National Congress could not get absolute majority during the general election of 1937 was –

- (a) Bombay (b) Assam
- (c) Orissa (d) Bihar

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2004

Ans. (*)

Indian National Congress could not get absolute majority in Bombay and Assam during 1936-37 A.D. general election.

7. The province where Indian National Congress did not form its ministry after general elections of 1937 was :

- (a) Bengal (b) Bihar
- (c) Madras (d) Orissa

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2008

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2004

U.P. P.C.S. (Mains) 2003

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

8. In how many provinces was the Congress ministry formed in the election of the year 1937?

- (a) 11 (b) 9
- (c) 6 (d) 3

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (*)

Provincial Assembly elections were held under the Government of India Act, 1935, in which Congress got a full majority in 5 states namely Madras, Central Province, Orissa, Bihar and United Province. In July, 1937 Congress formed its government in 6 provinces – Bombay, United Province,

Central Province, Orissa, Bihar and Madras. Later Congress formed coalition governments in NWFP and Assam. UPPSC did not evaluate this question.

9. In which one of the following provinces was the Congress ministry not formed under the Act of 1935?

- (a) Bihar (b) Madras
- (c) Orissa (d) Punjab

I.A.S. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

10. The tenure of the Congress ministries formed in the elections of 1937 after the Act of 1935 was:

- (a) 20 Months (b) 22 Months
- (c) 24 Months (d) 28 Months

U.P. P.C.S. (Mains) 2010

Ans. (d)

The tenure of the Congress ministries formed in the elections of 1936-37 A.D. under the Act of 1935 was 28 months. Congress ministries resigned from legislature on 22nd October 1939 A.D. because Indians were included in the Second World War without the consent of Indian leaders. Jinnah called All India Muslim League to celebrate 22nd December 1939 A.D. (Friday) as Day of Deliverance due to the resignation of Congress ministries.

11. After the formation of ministries in the province in 1937, Congress rule lasted for:

- (a) 28 months (b) 29 months
- (c) 30 months (d) 31 months

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2013

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

12. Muslim League celebrated the Day of Deliverance in :

- (a) 1939 (b) 1942
- (c) 1946 (d) 1947

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

13. The elected Government of Bihar formed by Shri Krishna Singh resigned in February 1938 for which reason?

- (a) Satyagraha against the British at the call of Gandhiji
- (b) Participation in the Freedom Struggle of India
- (c) For the release of political prisoners
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above